

VERTICAL COMPLIANCE PACKS

Written Information Security Plan (WISP) - CPA & Tax Preparer Edition

A complete Written Information Security Plan for CPA firms and tax preparers, ready to adopt: designate the coordinator, sign it, and keep it with the firm's records. BVTech operationalizes every safeguard below under a managed services agreement.

Document ID	BVT-VRT-181
Version	1.0
Effective date	July 28, 2026
Document owner	Jordan Polasek, Managing Partner
Classification	Internal - BVTech LLC Confidential
Review cycle	Annual, or upon material change
Counsel review	Recommended by licensed Texas counsel before first execution

Legal Basis

Federal law requires every professional tax preparer to have a written information security plan: the FTC Safeguards Rule (16 C.F.R. Part 314, under the Gramm-Leach-Bliley Act) applies to tax preparers as financial institutions, and IRS Publication 4557 ('Safeguarding Taxpayer Data') directs preparers to implement one. A current WISP is also attested when renewing a PTIN. This document satisfies that obligation when adopted, implemented, and reviewed annually.

Safeguards Program

1. Designated security coordinator

A qualified individual is designated to implement and supervise this WISP. For managed clients, BVTech LLC serves as the operational coordinator; the firm's principal retains ultimate accountability.

2. Risk assessment

The firm identifies where client data lives (tax software, email, portals, paper), the reasonably foreseeable internal and external risks to it, and assesses the sufficiency of safeguards at least annually and after any incident.

3. Access controls & MFA

Access to client data is limited to personnel who need it. Multi-factor authentication is required on email, tax software, remote access, and any system holding client records.

4. Encryption

Client data is encrypted in transit (TLS) and at rest on laptops, portable media, and cloud storage. Unencrypted transmission of returns or PII is prohibited.

5. Monitoring & anti-malware

Managed endpoint protection with real-time detection runs on every device; alerts are monitored and triaged by the coordinator.

6. Patch & configuration management

Operating systems and applications are patched on a managed cadence; unsupported software that touches client data is retired.

7. Employee training & discipline

All personnel receive security awareness training at hire and annually, including phishing recognition; violations of this WISP carry documented consequences.

8. Vendor oversight

Service providers that access client data are selected for their ability to maintain safeguards and are bound by written contract to do so.

9. Incident response & notification

Suspected data theft or breach triggers the incident response procedure, including required notifications (for tax preparers: the IRS Stakeholder Liaison and state authorities; in Texas, the Sec. 521.053 notification duties).

10. Data retention & destruction

Client records are retained only as long as required and destroyed securely (NIST 800-88) with certification. Devices are sanitized before disposal.

11. Continuous evaluation

This WISP is reviewed at least annually, on material change to operations, and after any security event, with revisions documented.

12. Additional vertical safeguards

EFIN/PTIN credentials are protected, never shared, and monitored for misuse; IRS e-Services accounts use the strongest available authentication.

13. Additional vertical safeguards

Client tax data leaves the firm only through encrypted portals - never as plain email attachments.

Adoption

Firm name: _____

Designated coordinator: _____

Adopted on (date): _____

Principal signature: _____

Annual review due: _____